ASX 200 Market Watch

Is there anything we should be watching? Last 90 trading days, Australian dates.

Data to: 27 Oct 2026
Sources: Yahoo Finance (^AXJO), RBA table F2

MARKET ACTIVITY SIGNAL

GREEN

14-day volatility is 0.53% a day, at the 24th percentile of the past 252 trading days.

- **Green**, below the 50th percentile: calmer than half of the past year. No action needed. **(today)**
- **Amber**, 50th to 80th: choppier than usual. Keep watching.
- **Red**, above the 80th: unusually jumpy, in the top fifth of the past year. Review.

Latest close
8,850

Close vs 20-day average
+1.0%

10-yr yield (RBA)
5.28%
to 21 Oct

14-day volatility
0.53%
Daily swings. Drives the signal

HOW TO READ THE YIELD LINK

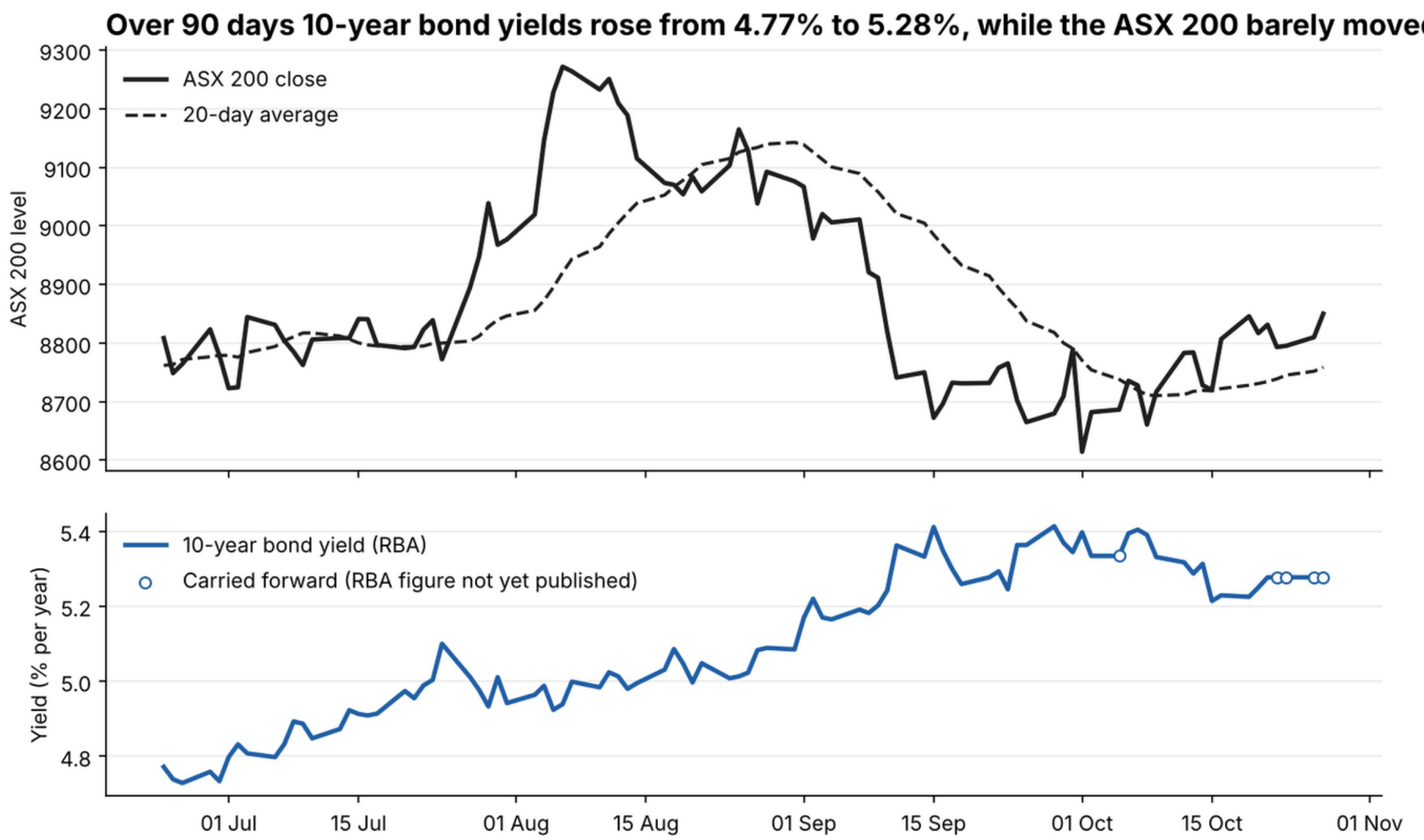
Over the last 30 trading days the share market and bond yields have moved in opposite directions: when yields rose, shares often fell (correlation -0.46, 24 valid days). Correlation is not cause: it describes what happened, not why.

WHAT TO WATCH NEXT

Volatility is 0.53% a day; the signal turns Amber above 0.69%. Watch whether the index holds above its 20-day average and whether the 10-year yield keeps rising from 5.28%.

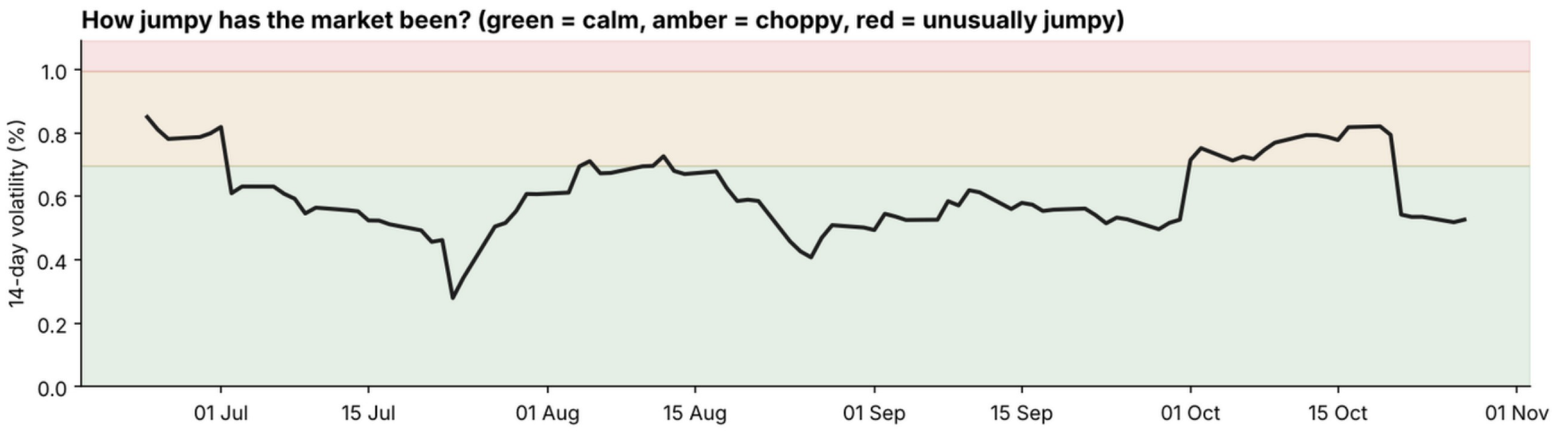
The ASX 200 is 4.5% below its recent high of 06 Aug

Over 90 days shares are roughly flat (+0.5%) while the 10-year bond yield rose from 4.77% to 5.28%. Day-to-day swings have been calmer than usual, so the signal is Green.



Same dates in both panels. Yields are the Australian Government 10-year bond yield; the two scales are separate on purpose.

The dashed line is the average over the past 20 trading days. The 10-year bond yield is the return the government pays to borrow. Hollow dots are yields not yet published by the RBA, so the last known value is carried forward.



About this data: ASX 200 daily closes from Yahoo Finance; Australian 10-year government bond yield from the RBA (table F2, series FCMYGBAG10D). The newest yields are carried forward from the last RBA publication (hollow markers). Latest day treated as provisional if volume is zero.

Design decisions

Audience: financially literate, non-technical users.
Each decision below answers one question: does this help them see what has happened over 90 days and what to watch?

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1. Signal first

I placed the Green/Amber/Red signal in the top-left corner so that the reader sees it first, instead of below the charts in a small font where it could be missed. Since the dashboard has to answer the question "Is there anything to watch?", a busy reader gets that answer straight away and can then decide whether to read further.

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2. The headline states the finding

I titled the main chart “The ASX 200 is 4.5% below its recent high of 06 Aug” instead of a label like “ASX 200 price”. That way, a reader skimming the page gets the point from the title alone, and the chart then shows the evidence.

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3. Stacked panels, not a dual axis

Instead of placing price and yield on a single chart with two vertical axes, I stacked them on top of each other. Two axes can make the lines cross for no real reason and give the reader a false sense that the two are related. Stacked, the reader can still compare when each one moved.

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4. Hollow dots for carried-forward yields

The share price data runs until 27 Oct, but the latest RBA yield is from 21 Oct, so the last few yield points are stand-ins (copies of the last real value). I marked them as hollow dots so the reader can tell them apart from real data, and chose not to hide them because that would have left a gap in the chart. This way the reader can see which points are real, and the footer explains why.

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5. Volatility chart shows why the colour is what it is

I put Green/Amber/Red bands on the chart itself. That way the user can see exactly where a point falls under the RAG rule, instead of blindly assuming or having to do a calculation.

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6. Volume left out

The brief offers either volume or price, so I chose price. The volume data had a zero on 29 June 2026 and repeated values, so a volume chart would have shown activity that doesn't exist. I kept volume only as a data check in the notebook.

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7. Plain-language correlation box

Most non-technical users would not know how to read correlation. So the box says it in words: “moved in opposite directions”, with the figure (-0.46) and the number of days behind it (24). It also says correlation is not cause, so a user doesn’t read the link as one thing driving the other.